

Developing a Simple Android Application Using Kotlin

Kotlin is a statically typed programming language specially designed for modern multi-platform applications. Experiment and use it to become the proud creator of your own Android app by following the simple instructions in this article.



Android, which was declared open source from the year 2007, works on Java and C++ as its official languages. In May 2017, at the Google I/O, it was announced that Kotlin, a statically typed programming language that is 100 per cent interoperable with Java, was also an official language of Android.

For current Android developers, Kotlin is a chance to use an Android-centric language to solve the usual problems, such as runtime exceptions and Java's lengthy coding. Google assures continued support for Java, which means that your existing coding patterns are preserved. Kotlin, on the other hand, is an easy solution for a beginner to get started with Android's own programming language.

Configuring Kotlin

Android Studio 3.0 comes with pre-installed Kotlin. For all other versions below 3.0, the user needs to install Kotlin manually as follows:

- Open *Settings (Preferences)* in Mac).
- Select *Plugins* and search for Kotlin (Figure 1).
- Hit *Install* to add Kotlin to your Android Studio.

Now, if the Android Studio version is not 3.0, we need to add the following code into the *build.gradle* (Project:

MyApplication) file (located at the bottom of the left side of the *Project* window, inside *Gradle Scripts*), under the dependencies section.

```
classpath "org.jetbrains.kotlin:kotlin-gradle-
plugin:$kotlin_version"
classpath "org.jetbrains.kotlin:kotlin-android-
extensions:$kotlin_version"
```

Also add the Kotlin version into the *buildscript* section, as follows:

```
ext.kotlin_version = '1.1.x'
```

Now, add the following line to the *build.gradle* (Module: app) file, as the second line, followed by the *com.android.application* plugin:

```
apply plugin: 'kotlin-android'
```

Creating a new project with Kotlin

Android Studio 3.0 users can directly select Kotlin as their default language while creating a new project; as usual,